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Mozilla has announced it will end support for 32-bit Linux builds of Firefox in October this year, closing a chapter that began with the browser's Linux debut in 2004. The final supported release, Firefox 144, is scheduled for October 14, 2025. Firefox 145 will be the first version to drop 32-bit Linux support.

Explaining the decision, Mozilla stated: "Maintaining Firefox on this platform has become increasingly difficult and unreliable." The organisation added that it will now focus engineering efforts on "delivering the best and most modern Firefox." The move reflects the declining use of 32-bit Linux distributions in recent years.

Google Chrome discontinued 32-bit Linux support in 2016, while Ubuntu dropped it in 2017. By contrast, Mozilla continued support far longer in order to help "users extend the life of their hardware and reduce unnecessary obsolescence."

For users still running 32-bit Linux systems, immediate disruption is limited. Firefox 144 will remain usable, though it will not receive future features or security patches. Firefox ESR 140 will continue to receive security updates until September 2026. For long-term reliability, migration to 64-bit hardware and distributions is recommended.

The end of 32-bit Linux support signals more than just a technical shift. It marks the conclusion of an era where open source developers resisted obsolescence in the interest of inclusivity and hardware longevity. With Firefox stepping away, the last major open source browser to support 32-bit Linux is gone, underscoring the ecosystem's definitive transition to 64-bit.

However, thanks to Firefox's open source foundations, community-driven forks could continue 32-bit builds for legacy hardware users, keeping the tradition alive beyond Mozilla's official withdrawal.

Open source RSL protocol launched to regulate AI data scraping

Reddit, Quora, Yahoo, and several other publishers have introduced Really Simple Licensing (RSL), an open, decentralised protocol designed to regulate AI data

Google's EmbeddingGemma will run natively on devices

Google has unveiled EmbeddingGemma, an open source embedding model designed to run natively on laptops, desktops, and mobile devices. With 308 million parameters and support for over 100 languages, the model is based on the Gemma 3 architecture and extends Google's push for efficient, device-ready AI.

EmbeddingGemma has secured the top spot on the Massive Text Embedding Benchmark (MTEB) multilingual v2 leaderboard for models under 500M parameters. It is engineered to deliver high-quality embeddings that enable retrieval augmented generation (RAG) and semantic search directly on hardware, eliminating reliance on cloud servers.

In a blog post, Min Choi, product manager, and Sahil Dua, lead research engineer at Google DeepMind, highlighted the model's flexibility and integrations: "EmbeddingGemma offers customisable output dimensions and will work with its open source Gemma 3n model. It integrates with tools like Ollama, llama.cpp, MLX, LiteRT, LMStudio, LangChain, LlamaIndex and Cloudflare."

"Designed specifically for on-



device AI, its highly efficient 308 million parameter

design enables you to build applications using techniques such as retrieval augmented generation (RAG) and semantic search that run directly on your hardware. It delivers private, high-quality embeddings that work anywhere, even without an internet connection."